

Hands-on Lab: Committing and Rolling Back a Transaction



Estimated time needed: 20 minutes

A transaction is simply a sequence of operations performed using one or more SQL statements as a single logical unit of work. A database transaction must be ACID (Atomic, Consistent, Isolated and Durable). The effects of all the SQL statements in a transaction can either be applied to the database using the COMMIT command or undone from the database using the ROLLBACK command.

In this lab, you will learn some commonly used TCL (Transaction Control Language) commands of SQL through the creation of a stored procedure routine. You will learn about COMMIT, which is used to permanently save the changes done in the transactions in a table, and about ROLLBACK, which is used to undo the transactions that have not been saved in a table. ROLLBACK can only be used to undo the changes in the current unit of work.

Objectives

After completing this lab, you will be able to:

- Permanently save the changes done in a transaction
- Undo the transaction that has not been saved

Software Used in this Lab

MySQL is a Relational Database Management System (RDBMS) designed to efficiently store, manipulate, and retrieve data.



To complete this lab you will utilize MySQL relational database service available as part of IBM Skills Network Labs (SN Labs) Cloud IDE. SN Labs is a virtual lab environment used in this course.

Database Used in this Lab

mysql_learners database has been used in this lab.

Data Used in this Lab

The data used in this lab is internal data. You will be working on the BankAccounts and ShoeShop tables.

ACCOUNTNUMBER	ACCOUNTNAME	BALANCE
B001	Rose	300.00
B002	James	1345.00
B003	Shoe Shop	124200.00
B004	Corner Shop	76000.00

PRODUCT	STOCK	PRICE
Boots	11	200.00
High heels	8	600.00
Brogues	10	150.00
Trainers	14	300.00

This lab requires you to have the BankAccounts and ShoeShop tables populated with sample data. Download the BankAccounts-CREATE.sql and ShoeShop-CREATE.sql scripts below, and load them to the phpMyAdmin console. The scripts will create new tables called BankAccounts and ShoeShop and populate them with the sample data required for this lab.

- [BankAccounts-CREATE.sql](#)
- [ShoeShop-CREATE.sql](#)

Sample Exercise

Example of committing and rolling back a transaction.

1. **Scenario:** Rose is buying a pair of boots from shoeShop. So we have to update Rose's balance as well as the shoeShop balance in the BankAccounts table. Then we also have to update Boots stock in the shoeShop table. After Boots, let's also attempt to buy Rose a pair of Trainers.
 - Once the tables are ready, create a stored procedure routine named TRANSACTION_ROSE that includes TCL commands like COMMIT and ROLLBACK.
 - Now develop the routine based on the given scenario to execute a transaction.
 - To create the stored procedure routine on MySQL, copy the code below and paste it to the textarea of the SQL page. Click Go.

```
DELIMITER //
CREATE PROCEDURE TRANSACTION_ROSE()
BEGIN
    DECLARE EXIT HANDLER FOR SQLSTATE*
    BEGIN
        ROLLBACK;
        RESIGNAL;
    END;
    START TRANSACTION;
    UPDATE BankAccounts
    SET Balance = Balance-200
    WHERE AccountName = 'Rose';
    UPDATE BankAccounts
    SET Balance = Balance+200
    WHERE AccountName = 'Shoe Shop';
    UPDATE ShoeShop
    SET Stock = Stock-1
    WHERE Product = 'Boots';
    UPDATE BankAccounts
    SET Balance = Balance-300
    WHERE AccountName = 'Rose';
    COMMIT;
END //
DELIMITER ;
```

3. Let's now check if the transaction can successfully be committed or not. Copy the code below in a **new blank script** and paste it to the textarea of the **SQL** page. Click **Go**

```
CALL TRANSACTION_ROSE;  
SELECT * FROM BankAccounts;  
SELECT * FROM ShoeShop;
```

4. Observe that the transaction has been executed. But when we observe the tables, no changes have permanently been saved through COMMIT. All the possible changes happened might have been undone through ROLLBACK since the whole transaction fails due to the failure of a SQL statement or more. Let's go through the possible reason behind the failure of the transaction and how COMMIT - ROLLBACK works on a stored procedure:

- The first three UPDATEs should run successfully. Both the balance of Rose and ShoeShop should have been updated in the BankAccounts table. The current balance of Rose should stand at 300 - 200 (price of a pair of Boots) = 100. The current balance of ShoeShop should stand at 124,200 + 200 = 124,400. The stock of Boots should also be updated in the ShoeShop table after the successful purchase for Rose, 11 - 1 = 10.
- The last UPDATE statement tries to buy Rose a pair of Trainers, but her balance becomes insufficient (Current balance of Rose: 100 < Price of Trainers: 300) after buying a pair of Boots. So, the last UPDATE statement fails. Since the whole transaction fails if any of the SQL statements fail, the transaction won't be committed.

Practice exercise

Now let's practice an exercise on committing and rolling back a transaction.

Create a stored procedure **TRANSACTION_JAMES** to execute a transaction based on the following scenario: First buy James 4 pairs of Trainers from ShoeShop. Update his balance as well as the balance of ShoeShop. Also, update the stock of Trainers at ShoeShop. Then attempt to buy James a pair of Brogues from ShoeShop. If any of the UPDATE statements fail, the whole transaction fails. You will roll back the transaction. Commit the transaction only if the whole transaction is successful.

- Hint
- Solution

Conclusion

Congratulations! You have completed this lab, and you are ready for the next topic.

You are now able to:

- Write a stored procedure to record a transaction in multiple tables
- Understand the difference between permanent and rollable transactions
- Perform a transaction
- Perform a rollback

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